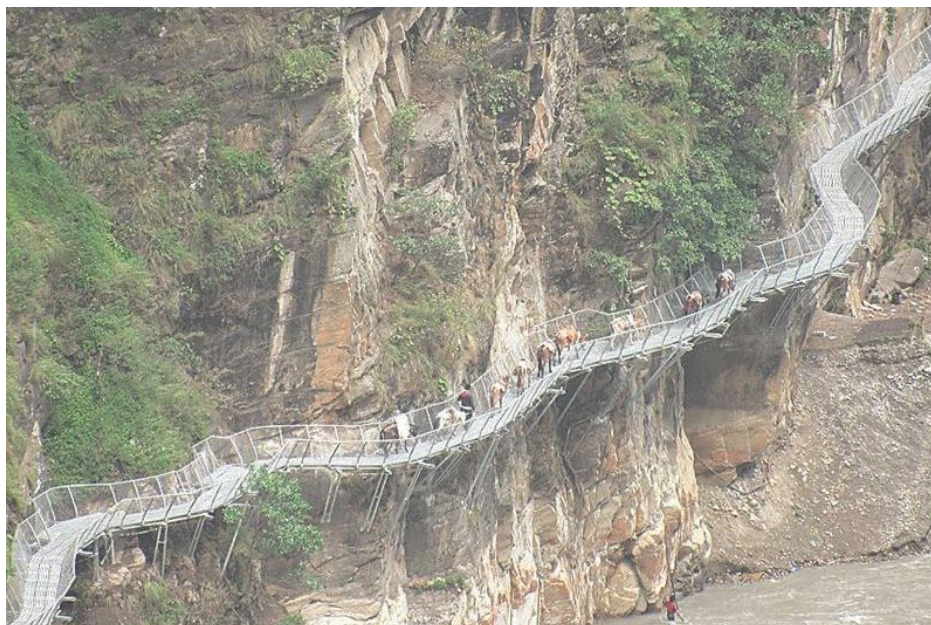


WEEKLY BULLETIN

29 January 2018



[Yaru Bagar cantilever bridge, Northern Gorkha](#): constructed by the UK Aid funded Samarth project, the bridge, one of two constructed, has reconnected the Tsum and Nubri valleys which were cut off after the April 2015 earthquake when the only road way in or out was damaged. A 117m long pathway along Syar Khola has reconnected Tsum valley to the main road and a longer 195m long pathway along Yaru Bagar has re-opened the popular Manaslu trekking route, which is part of the Great Himalaya Trail (GHT). The bridges use a unique engineering technology to drill into the cliffs to secure a platform, in a way that is safe from landslides. With this rural infrastructure in place, travel time has shortened significantly, the price of goods has decreased, and reaching schools, markets and hospitals is easier and safer. The construction of the pathways provided jobs to 180 villagers, earning them close to 6.1 million rupees for three months' work.

Highlights

- Round 2 of [HRRP Partner Satisfaction Survey](#) launched – please complete the survey and help us improve!
- As of 23 January ([Nepali](#), [Unofficial English Translation](#)), the number of households approved for the second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant has crossed the 200,000 mark
- [Common Feedback Project, Reconstruction and Food Security and Livelihoods Report, December 2017](#): the report highlights that there has been no narrowing of the gap between men and women in their access to information or knowledge of the reconstruction process during 2017. Sincere and concerted effort needs to be made in 2018 to close this gap.
- [Cabinet decisions on senior citizen allowance and additional 100,000 NPRs support for earthquake, landslide, and flood affected households](#) – it is unclear if, or how, the additional 100,000 NPRs would be distributed, and to who.
- [Kathmandu Metropolitan City Division to provide building permit information through SMS service](#)

UPDATES & REQUESTS

National

MoFALD CLPIU Enrolment Data, as of 28 January ([Nepali](#) and [Unofficial English Translation](#)):

	5 January	17 January	28 January
Total No. Eligible HHs	767,704	771,220	767,705
HHs Enrolled	678,097 (88.3%)	683,475 (88.6%)	684,468 (89.2%)
HHs Received 1st Tranche	666,977 (86.9%)	669,542 (86.8%)	671,495 (87.5%)
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	129,668 (16.9%)	150,798 (19.6%)	162,114 (21.1%)
HHs Received 3rd Tranche	31,535 (4.1%)	37,662 (4.9%)	40,487 (5.3%)

In recent weeks the total number of eligible households reported by MoFALD has fluctuated; the HRRP team are currently in the process of trying to determine why this is. On 23 January, NRA published news ([Nepali](#), [Unofficial English Translation](#)) that the number of households approved for the second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant has crossed the 200,000 mark based on [MoUD CLPIU data](#). This data shows that 204,993 households have been approved for the second tranche. Please note that the difference between MoFALD CLPIU and MoUD CLPIU data is because MoUD CLPIU report when the household has been approved for the tranche and MoFALD CLPIU report when the tranche has been released to the household's bank account and there may be a lag between approval and release of the tranche to the bank account.

[Cabinet decisions on senior citizen allowance and additional support for earthquake, landslide, and flood affected households:](#) during a cabinet meeting on Wednesday, 24 January, it was decided to reduce the age requirement for the senior citizen allowance from 70 to 65. It was also decided that an additional 100,000 NPRs will be provided to households affected by earthquake, landslides, or flooding that are still living in temporary shelters due to a lack of funds to start their reconstruction. The extra 100,000 NPRs is intended to support improvements to living conditions for these households. The NRA have since stated that they are unable to provide the extra 100,000 NPRs. Further details on how this will be resolved are expected in the coming week.

[National Symposium held on Earthquake Risk Management and Risk Reduction, 21 & 22 January:](#) the event, held to mark Earthquake Safety Day, brought together a wide range of reconstruction actors to discuss on 12 thematic sessions, with a particular focus on the impacts of the new federal structure.



Deputy Mayor of Kageshwori Manahora raising a question during the symposium.

HRRP Technical Session on Repair and Retrofit, 12 January: many thanks to all who participated in the session. The session report is available [here](#) and the presentations are available [here](#).

NRA instructs partners to focus on implementation of PDRF, (Nepali): during a meeting with partners on 22 January to discuss progress so far on implementation of the PDRF, NRA Secretary Madhu Sudan Adhikari directed partners to prioritise projects remaining within the PDRF above new projects, and to give top priority to projects which relate to earthquake survivors.

World Economic Forum, Nepal ranks 22 in Inclusive Development Index 2018: according to the '[Inclusive Development Index 2018 Summary and Data Highlights](#)', released by the WEF on 22 January, Nepal is not only the highest rank South Asian country but is also ranked ahead of China. [The Inclusive Development Index IDI](#) is an annual assessment among 103 countries where they are ranked according to their GDP and eleven dimensions of economic progress.

China donates solar power generation system to Nepal: the Chinese Government has donated 32,000 sets of household solar power generation system (10Wp) and 325 sets of solar power generation system (1200Wp), battery, controller, LED bulb and case that include status indicator and system cable as part of efforts to support combating climate change in Nepal. The goods will be distributed by the [Alternative Energy Promotion Center \(AEPIC\)](#) to districts affected by the 2015 Earthquake (Sindhupalchowk, Kavre, Nuwakot, Dhading and Lamjung).

Land prices in provincial capitals jumps four-fold: since the announcement of the provincial capitals, the price of land in the capitals has skyrocketed. Surkhet, Dhangadhi, and Janakpur have seen up to four-fold increase in the price of land.

Districts

[HRRP District Coordination Team Dolakha, Weekly District Report, 19 - 25 Jan 2018](#)



Dolakha, Melung Rural Municipality, Ward-4: locally trained masons working on the construction of a stone and mud mortar masonry house with RCC bands. The homeowner has only received the first tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant to date.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu, Weekly District Report, 19 - 25 Jan 2018



Kathmandu, Changunarayan Municipality, Pokharel, Ward-4: two storey RC frame house with brick masonry infill under construction. The home owner has received the first tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhuli, Weekly District Report, 19 - 25 Jan 2018



Sindhuli, Hariharpurgadhi Rural Municipality, Ward-2: a hybrid structure with masonry ground floor and timber first floor which is now being used for the Rural Municipality office. The home owner is waiting to receive the third tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

'Saving the earth with earth bricks': a Nepali Times article about the use of Compressed Stabilised Earth Blocks (CSEB) in earthquake affected areas. The report looks at the potential for CSEB to reduce air pollution in Kathmandu (due to reduction in brick kiln pollution), lower the cost of construction, and to make construction of seismic-resistant buildings easier. The [DUDBC Design Catalogue Volume 2](#) includes designs using CSEB but the compliance and inspection requirements for CSEB have yet to be finalised so houses using CSEB cannot at the moment be approved for the tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant. HRRP has also found that uptake of CSEB is not happening organically and PO intervention is required to push this material.



Rasuwa: Women being trained to use compactors to manufacture Compressed Earth bricks, which is cost effective and more seismic resistant. Photo: Build up Nepal

Correction, Dolakha, GI Wire Containment Technology, Comprehensive Disaster Risk Management Programme (CDRMP)/UNDP: it was incorrectly reported in last week's bulletin that it costs 60,000 to 70,000 NPRs for the construction of a two room stone and mud mortar masonry house. The actual cost is 300,000 to 400,000 NPRs. UNDP has constructed 24 Technology Demonstration Houses (TDHs) through 50 days On-The-Job training and 34 houses through reconstruction grant support up to 50,000 NPRs (in kind). The local community is replicating this technology in Boch, Lakuridanda, Katakuti, Magapauwa, and Phasku and more than 30 houses are being built following this technique.

Requests for Partner Support

Round 2, HRRP Partner Satisfaction Survey: the HRRP team is pleased to invite all partners to take part in the survey and help us improve our services. As a stakeholder in the earthquake recovery and reconstruction effort, the HRRP is your platform and your feedback will help to shape it. The survey should take approximately 10 to 15 minutes to complete, but will take longer if you choose to provide more detailed feedback in the open answer questions, and can be conducted in Nepali or English. The survey will be open until COB 16 February. More detailed feedback on the HRRP can be also be sent at any time to info@hrrpnepal.org. The results of the first round of the Partner Satisfaction Survey can be accessed here http://bit.ly/HRRP_Survey_2017. Many thanks to all those who provided input in the last round, it was very valuable and has helped adjust our activities.

Communicating with Disaster Affected Communities (CDAC) Network event, 'Radio - A beacon of progress in today's tech-led communication landscape', 13 February, 15:30-18:00 CET: this webinar will mark World Radio Day and will comprise two sessions; i) Evidence of the link between radio and the health of disaster-affected communities in the case of Typhoon Haiyan, and ii) Radio's vital role in today's situations of irregular migration and conflict.

DOCUMENTS & PRODUCTS

Government of Nepal

[MoFALD Environment Management Section \(EFLG\), notice for recruitment of EFLG District Associate:](#) MoFALD, UNCDF, and PEI have agreed to implement a one-year, EFLG Transition program for 2017/18. To ensure continuity of the EFLG towards a larger program design for 2018/19 and beyond, MoFALD Environment Management Section is seeking an EFLG District Associate for Kavre and Sindhuli Districts through the local governance and community development program (TSNGP).

[Kathmandu Metropolitan City Division to provide building permit information through SMS service:](#) households will be able to check the progress of their application for approval of drawings, as well as accessing other related information by logging on to <http://sastosms.com/auth/login> using the registration number they have been provided when registering their drawings for approval. They will also receive updates on the process via sms.

HRRP

[Housing Reconstruction Progress Maps:](#) based on MoUD CLPIU inspection data as of 22 January.

[Partnership Agreement Signed between HH and GoN](#)

[1st Tranche Received](#)

[Construction Started](#)

[Compliance Rate – 2nd Tranche](#)

[Compliance Rate – 3rd Tranche](#)

[Construction Completed](#)

[HRRP District Profiles](#), as per HRRP 4W data from 10 January:

[Bhaktapur](#)

[Dhading](#)

[Dolakha](#)

[Gorkha](#)

[Kathmandu](#)

[Kavre](#)

[Lalitpur](#)

[Makwanpur](#)

[Nuwakot](#)

[Okhaldhunga](#)

[Ramechhap](#)

[Rasuwa](#)

[Sindhuli](#)

[Sindhupalchowk](#)

Partners

Common Feedback Project, Reconstruction and Food Security and Livelihoods Report, December 2017: this is the last report from CFP for 2017 and provides the results of the last community perception survey of 2017, as well as looking back over the full year. Overall, the report highlights several areas where significant progress has been made over the course of 2017, including rate of engineer consultation and the perception of communities that the reconstruction process is making progress. It also draws attention to the fact that there has been no narrowing of the gap between men and women in their access to information or knowledge of the reconstruction process. Sincere and concerted effort needs to be made in 2018 to close this gap.

Milijuli Nepali, BBC Media Action, Episode 850: this episode is an on-location programme recorded in Bhumlu Rural Municipality-7, Phalete, in Kavre district. The episode includes an episode of the KathaMaala drama focused on the construction of Pati Pauwa (public rest house) and cultural heritage. The programme also includes interviews with residents of Bhumlu and ward chairman Ramesh Raj Kharel who talked about the reconstruction of Pati Pauwa and the need to restore and preserve cultural heritage in the reconstruction.

Baliyo Ghar TV Programme, Episode 88: this week's programme is focused on 'Housing Reconstruction in the Changed Context of Federalism: Status, Issues and Challenges' including footage from the session on this topic at the National Symposium 2018 organised as part of Earthquake Safety Day events. The show airs on Sunday at 7PM on Kantipur TV, News 24 TV on Wednesday at 8AM and Avenues TV on Saturday at 8:30AM with repeats on each.



संघीय संरचनामा आवास पुनर्निर्माणको अवस्था, विषय र चुनौतिहरू

भाग - ८८






Sunday 7:00 PM &
Monday 01:30 PM



Wednesday 8:00 AM, 2:00 PM
& Thursday 04:30 AM



Saturday 8:30 AM
Sunday 04:30 AM & 03:00 PM

Supported By:



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Media Partner:



Environmental Performance Index 2018, Yale University: the EPI has determined air quality in Nepal to be the worst in the world, and Nepal has been ranked 176 out of 180 in terms of overall environmental performance.

Country Profile NEPAL



2018 EPI Country Rank (out of 180)

176

EPI Score [0=worst, 100=best]

31.44

Population (millions)

29.0

Land Area (sq. km)

143,350

GDP (PPP 2011\$ billions)

66.6

GDP per capita

2,298

SDG Index*

61.6



A snapshot from the [EPI Nepal Profile](#).

[The World Economic Forum, Gender Gap Report 2016](#): the report quantifies the magnitude of gender disparities and tracks their progress over time, with a specific focus on the relative gaps between women and men across four key areas: health, education, economy, and politics.



Infographic showing the Gap in Wages earned by Women with and without children, in South Asia and Sub Saharan Nations, source: UNWOMEN

[World Employment and Social Outlook, Trends 2018, ILO](#): the report examines the current state of the labour market, assessing the most recent developments and making global and regional projections of unemployment, vulnerable employment, and working poverty. The report highlights that there almost 1.4 billion workers were in vulnerable employment in 2017, and that an additional 35 million are expected to join them by 2019. In developing countries, vulnerable employment affects three out of four workers.

[Overseas Development Institute \(ODI\), Resilience Scan, a review of literature, debates and social media on resilience July–September 2017](#)

[USAID Humanitarian Assistance in Review: South Asia for the Fiscal Year \(FY\) 2008 – 2017](#)

[World Economic Forum, Global Risk Report 2018](#): the report highlights the growing strain on many global systems and looks at risks which have been analysed in previous Global Risk Reports, tracing the evolution of the risks themselves and the global responses to them.

[Media Digest](#) | [FAQ](#) | [Briefing Pack](#) | [Meeting & Events](#) | [4W](#) | [Housing Progress](#) | [Housing Typologies](#)